

Karl Mulligan

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Germany

Academic positions

2025 – Present **Universität Tübingen** – Tübingen, Germany
Postdoctoral Researcher, Seminar für Sprachwissenschaft

Education

2019 – 2025 **Johns Hopkins University** – Baltimore, MD
PhD in Cognitive Science
Dissertation title: *Shifting Topic*
Committee: Kyle Rawlins (chair), Justin Bledin, Jennifer Hu, Pasha Koval, Benjamin Van Durme

2019 – 2021 **Johns Hopkins University** – Baltimore, MD
MA in Cognitive Science

2015 – 2019 **Rutgers University** – New Brunswick, NJ
BS in Computer Science; BA in Linguistics, Cognitive Science

Fall 2016 **Universitat de València** – Valencia, Spain
Semester abroad in the Faculty of Philology, Translation, and Communication

Research experience

Summer 2018 **Jelinek Workshop on Speech and Language Technology** – Baltimore, MD
Center for Language and Speech Processing, Johns Hopkins University
PI: Lucia Specia • Mentor: Desmond Elliott

Summer 2017 **CSLI Summer Internship Program** – Stanford, CA
Center for the Study of Language and Information, Stanford University
PI: Noah D. Goodman • Mentors: Robert D. Hawkins, Judith Fan

Summer 2016 **Aresty Summer Science Program** – Piscataway, NJ
Aresty Research Center, Rutgers University
PI: Karin Stromswold

Publications

- 2026 Tsvilodub, Polina, **Karl Mulligan**, Todd Snider, Robert D. Hawkins, and Michael Franke. “Act or Clarify? Modeling Sensitivity to Uncertainty and Cost in Communication.” *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*, 48.
- 2025 **Mulligan, Karl** and Kyle Rawlins. “Analyzing naturally-sourced Questions Under Discussion.” *Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM)*, 3, 250-261.
- 2024 **Mulligan, Karl** and Kyle Rawlins. “Identifying Questions Under Discussion in Naturalistic Discourse.” *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL)*, 7, 357-361.
- 2023 **Mulligan, Karl** and Kyle Rawlins. “Perspectival biscuits.” *Proceedings of Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 33.
- 2022 **Mulligan, Karl** and Kyle Rawlins. “A compositional semantics for spatial perspective-shifting adjuncts.” *Proceedings of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL)* 40, 244-253.
- 2021 **Mulligan, Karl**, Robert Frank, and Tal Linzen. “Structure Here, Bias There: Hierarchical Generalization by Jointly Learning Syntactic Transformations.” *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL)*, 4, 125–135.
- 2020 Specia, Lucia, et al. (incl. **Karl Mulligan**). “Grounded Sequence to Sequence Transduction.” *IEEE Journal of Selected Topics in Signal Processing* 14, no. 3: 577–591.

Conference talks

- 2024 **Mulligan, Karl** and Kyle Rawlins. “Says who? An evidential challenge for English.” *Workshop on evidentials in non-canonical speech-acts (co-located with Sinn und Bedeutung 29)*. Siracusa, Italy.
- 2023 **Mulligan, Karl** and Kyle Rawlins. “Perspectival biscuits.” *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 33. New Haven, CT.
- 2021 **Mulligan, Karl**, Robert Frank, and Tal Linzen. “Structure Here, Bias There: Hierarchical Generalization by Jointly Learning Syntactic Transformations.” *Society for Computation for Linguistics (SCiL)* 4. Online.

Posters

- 2026 **Mulligan, Karl.** “Antagonistic *Why?* as metacommunicative resistance.” *Workshop on At-issueness and Commitment: Interfaces and Interactions*. Frankfurt, Germany.
- 2024 **Mulligan, Karl** and Kyle Rawlins. “Identifying Questions Under Discussion in Naturalistic Discourse.” *Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL)* 7. Irvine, CA.
- 2024 **Mulligan, Karl** and Kyle Rawlins. “Identifying QUDs in Naturalistic Discourse.” *Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM)* 3. Philadelphia, PA.
- 2019 **Mulligan, Karl**, Aldo Mayro, Paul de Lacy, Gwendolyn Rehrig, Karin Stromswold. (presented by Megan Kenny). “Who lengthened my verb stem? Prosodic words and phrases.” *90th Annual Meeting of the Eastern Psychological Association*. New York, NY.

Non peer-reviewed posters and presentations

- 2024 **Mulligan, Karl.** “All-natural Questions Under Discussion.” Talk given at the 10th Mid-Atlantic Colloquium of Studies in Meaning (MACSIM). College Park, MD.
- 2023 **Mulligan, Karl**, Kyle Rawlins. “Crowdsourcing QUD Annotations.” Poster presented at the 9th Mid-Atlantic Colloquium of Studies in Meaning (MACSIM). Philadelphia, PA.
- 2021 **Mulligan, Karl.** “A compositional semantics for spatial perspective-shifting adjuncts.” Brown Bag talk series, JHU Cognitive Science. Baltimore, MD.
- 2017 **Mulligan, Karl**, Robert D. Hawkins, Judith Fan. “Communicating about objects in context.” Talk given at the conclusion of the 4th Annual Center for the Study of Language and Information (CSLI) Summer Internship Program. Stanford, CA.
- 2017 **Mulligan, Karl**, Aldo Mayro, Paul de Lacy, Gwendolyn Rehrig, Karin Stromswold. “Effects of verb stem lengthening by sentence construction.” Poster presented at the 11th Annual Rutgers Center for Cognitive Science (RuCCS) Perceptual Science Forum. Piscataway, NJ.

Teaching experience

- Fall 2024 **Psycholinguistics**, Teaching Assistant
Johns Hopkins University
- Spring 2022 **Bilingualism**, Teaching Assistant
Johns Hopkins University
- Fall 2021 **Semantics**, Teaching Assistant
Johns Hopkins University

Spring 2021	Phonology , Teaching Assistant Johns Hopkins University
Spring 2020	Language and Thought , Teaching Assistant Johns Hopkins University

Honors and awards

2020	NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program , Honorable Mention
2019	Paul Robeson Scholar , School of Arts and Sciences, Rutgers
2019	Award for Academic Excellence , Department of Linguistics, Rutgers
2018-2019	Phi Beta Kappa
2015-2019	Dean's List (x8), Rutgers
2015	Alpha Delta Phi Literary Competition , 1st Prize
2015	Presidential Scholarship , Rutgers (4-year full tuition, room, board)
2015	National Merit Scholar

Service

2021-Present	Colloquium Organizing Committee , JHU CogSci, member
2021-Present	Prospective Student Mentoring Program , JHU CogSci, mentor
2022	Omega Psi "Applying to Graduate School" Panel , panelist
2021-2022	Diversity and Representation Committee , JHU CogSci, member

Technical skills

Programming languages

Python, Javascript, R, SQL

Other technical skills

Unix Shell, $\LaTeX$, Git, CSS, HTML, Praat

Natural languages

English (native), Spanish (C1), Mandarin Chinese (heritage, spoken only), French (A2), Italian (A2), German (A1)